The Weary Boar

A Ravenloft module

Thorsteinn Mar

Introduction

The Weary Boar is designed for 4-6 level 2-3 PCs and non-evil alignment, a good balance of character classes is advised. It takes place in Barovia along the Old Svalich Road, using Barovia as it is described in the module **Curse of Strahd**. The module can be run using any setting where you'd find a roadside inn. All encounters can easily be modified to fit either a larger or a smaller party.

Just as a storm hits Barovia the PCs stumble upon a cozy and welcoming inn, The Weary Boar. As the storm rages and the night falls, the PCs and the other guests soon become aware of that everything is not as it seemed and that there's more to the Weary Boar than meets the eye and something terrible happened there. Will the PCs survive the night?

This book is meant for the Dungeon Master and refers the P**layer's Handbook**, **Dungeon Master's Guide**, **Monster Manual** and **Curse of Strahd**. Spells and items are described in the Player's Handbook, magic items can be found in Dungeon Master's Guide and stat blocks for monsters and villains are in the Monster Manual, unless otherwise noted.

Adventure background

Many years ago, Dalizmir Tirminski was a member of small party from Barovia, who wanted to live by the tenets of the Order of the Silver Dragons. Dalizmir and his friends, the siblings Isabella and Marek, ventured from the village to find the Amber Temple. A few nights after they had left Barovia they encountered a lone dwarf, Durgur Coalstone, and offered him a place by their fire.

That night Dalizmir woke up from a terrible nightmare, sweating and frightened. He found himself naked and somewhere deep in the Barovian woods. The night was cold and he could hear wolves howl, squirrels sleep and mice walk softly across the forest floor. Not far away, he could hear his friends speak together in hushed tones. They seemed afraid.

He rushed back to them, only to find Isabella and Durgur armed. Marek lay still by the fire, bloody bandages wrapped around his head. As he saw them raise their weapons and eye him warily, his anger swelled inside him. Something feral took control of him, his body changed and took on a more boar-like appearance. He charged his friends head first.

When the sun rose bleak Dalizmir realized what he had done. He wept as he buried his friends and the dwarf that had shared their fire. He didn't dare to return to Barovia, fearing that the villagers might

know what he had done. So, he wandered the woods for a few years where he learned more about the his lycanthropy curse, before he came upon a ruined house by the Old Svalich Road.

Dalizmir decided to rebuild the house as an inn, which he named The Weary Boar. Three years after he opened, a merchant and his daughter, Nyanka, spent the night at the Weary Boar. Dalizmir fell in love with Nyanka and almost a year later they married.

Nyanka became pregnant and as her belly grew, so did Dalizmir's anxiety. He feared more than everything that his unborn child would inherit his curse. He had a tough time controlling his temper and the more he tried, more violent he became. Usually he would heed the curse's call once a month, shape change and go run in the woods. But as it grew closer to Nyanka giving birth he went more and more often to the woods, to vent his fear and anger.

One stormy night Nyanka gave birth to a strong baby boy. As Dalizmir saw the boy his heart sank. As he cradled the boy in his arms he could smell that his son was a wereboar, like him. In his mind's eye he could see the evils that the boy would do, how he would betray his friends and kill travelers in the woods. As he stared into the baby's innocent blue eyes, his anger took control and he knew that he could not let this baby live.

Nyanka screamed as Dalizmir took on a horrible form, his face contorted and altered and two large tusks grew from his mouth. He slowly crushed the baby boy in his hands. Nyanka, weakened after giving birth to the baby, begged and pleaded to Dalizmir to spare the boy, but to no avail. As he turned to face her, the horror of it all crushing her mind and she became hysterical. She screamed and cried and laughed, all at once. Even when Dalizmir took her head and smashed it to the floor, she didn't seem to notice, but kept of laughing, crying and screaming. Dalizmir, shamed and disgusted with himself, tore out a panel in the wall, and shoved the body of the baby boy in there, before burying Nyanka in a tomb he made not far from The Weary Boar.

Recent developments

A year ago, Dalizmir remarried, this time a girl from the village Vallaki called Viola. She is oblivious to her husband's curse, though she's a bit concerned about his ever more erratic behavior of late. The thing is, she's pregnant…

Adventure overview

The PCs discover, while they are travelling along the Old Svalich Road, the Weary Boar Inn, just as a storm is about to hit the woods. As they spend the night in the inn, they soon discover that the ghost of Nyanka is still there, looking for her baby boy, whom she calls Anatolyi. One of the other guests is found murdered and Dalizmir begs the PCs to find the murderer, hoping to divert suspicion from himself. As the night wears on, the storm grows stronger and just before dawn Viola feels the first contractions. Dalizmir loses control and attacks his wife. It's up to the PCs to discover Dalizmir's secret, save Viola and help Nyanka find rest in the afterlife.

Adventure setup

The Weary Boar is divided into three distinct parts; key to the Weary Boar Inn and NPCs, Events and

Making players feel the dread

There are many ways to make players feel the dread and horror the PCs are experiencing, some of which are detailed and explained in DMG. There are also a few handy tricks that can help you convey the right atmosphere. Beside using background music and dim the lights, there are a few things that you can do which can make players feel the fear their characters are (hopefully) experiencing.

Less is more - By focusing on few details, but describing them well, you help your players visualize the events. Their imagination will fill up the rest.

Ask them for details - Do they use their left hand or their right hand to open the door? Make a note of it. If the opportunity arises, make a use of it.

Rolling dice - Just by rolling a die behind the screen, asking for one PC's skill or save modifier, then nodding and noting something down, will have the player's wondering. Let something happen one time you roll.

Take your time - When things are moving fast in-game, e.g. combat, take your time. Go full force into describing what's happening, make the dice rolls have a dramatic effect on your descriptions. When things are moving slow in-game, speed them up.

Don't overuse any of these and remember, the dread should be felt, not imposed. It's all about show, not tell. And remember, have fun.

Triggered Events. Events happen at certain points in the story, but Triggered events are triggered by the PCs actions.

It's important to familiarize yourself with the story and read through the module before running it.

Mood and atmosphere

Dalizmir's story, though bloody and terrible, is a sad one. Dalizmir hates what he is, but desires to be a father. He abhors his curse and what he has done, yet he is selfish enough to keep his murders secret.

The Weary Boar Inn is his attempt at being normal. The inn is cozy and welcoming, the staff friendly and nice. Still, there's a hint of deep sorrow edged into everything in there, something that all guests feel almost the moment they step into the inn. Few, if anyone, ever sleeps well and wakes up refreshed.

The staff knows that Dalizmir has a trouble with his temper and they seem to suffer heavily from Stockholm Syndrome, ready to find excuses and explain Dalizmir's action. The relationship between them and their master should be felt like that, though Dalizmir is careful to never hit his staff.

Small events to add to the atmosphere:

- When a PC enter room 15 alone, he/she hears a rattle coming from the walls.
- The wind howls outside, for just a moment it's almost as if it cries: My baby, my baby! When the PCs make a discovery.
- A thunder rolls across the sky, whenever the PCs try to pick a lock.
- The candles flicker and the light seems to diminish when the PCs speak about Viola and her baby.
- If a PC is alone (not in room 15) she feels as if someone walks past her, followed by a faint rotten smell.
- Whenever a PC looks in mirror or through window, the number 6 forms on the glass.

The Weary Boar

A storm is brewing

The PCs are travelling along the Old Svalich Road, when the grey sky above turns darker. With a successful DC 10 Wisdom (Survival) check the PCs feel that a storm is brewing and that they need to find shelter, sooner than later.

> The pine woods surround the Old Svalich Road and cast a dim shadow over it. All day long the grey clouds above have become ever darker and the wind has started to shake the trees. A storm is brewing.

As the PCs start searching for shelter, with a successful **DC 10 Wisdom (Perception) check** they spot a warm and inviting light not far away.

> As you trek on the wind grows stronger and rain starts pouring down as the daylight waines. The light you saw down the road seems to be a bit further away than you reckoned. Somewhere, not far away a wolf howls, followed by series of howls.

A pack of **6 wolves** (see MM p. 341) attacks the PCs. The weather goes from bad to worse. The PCs gear is soaked and they are wet to the bone. With a successful **DC 10 Wisdom (Survival) check** they discover that if they don't find a suitable shelter soon, this will be a very long and cold night. Read further if the PCs decide to trek on.

> Finally, you see the source of the light. A two-story wooden house with a steep roof stands by the road. The warm light floods out the windows, almost beckoning you to come closer. Not far away you hear a wolf howl.

The door to the Weary Boar is unlocked.

Key to the Weary Boar

The Weary Boar is a three-story house including attic, with stone foundation and wooden frame, with a steep roof. The foundation and cellar is older than the house itself, with a successful **DC 12 Intelligence or Stonecunning check** the PCs know this.

The Weary Boar Inn features

The Weary Boar appears to be a cozy and welcoming inn. Still, as the PCs spend more time there, more they should feel how terrible wrong the house feels. Like something terrible happened there and the house mourns it.

Walls and floors

The inn has wooden floors throughout, and all windows have hinges that allow them to swing outwards. The floors and wall panels are well oiled. All furniture looks good and expensive. Ceilings vary in height by floor. The cellar has but 8-foot-high ceilings, the first floor has 10-foot-high ceilings and the second floor has 8-12 foot-high ceiling, due to the steep roof.

Doors

All doors inside the house are made of wood and easy to break, with a successful **DC 15 Strength check** the PCs manage to kick in or break through the door. Doors into the house are wrought with iron and much sturdier, with a successful **DC 22 Strength check** the PCs manage to break through the door. There's a lock on every door but unless otherwise noted, every door is unlocked. The locks are simple, with a successful **DC 12 Dexterity check** the PCs manage to unlock the door.

Light and visibility

Unless otherwise noted there are candles burning in chandeliers in the hallways and the common room. In every room is a small oil lamp and a candle. In the cellar there are torches in sconces on the walls.

First floor

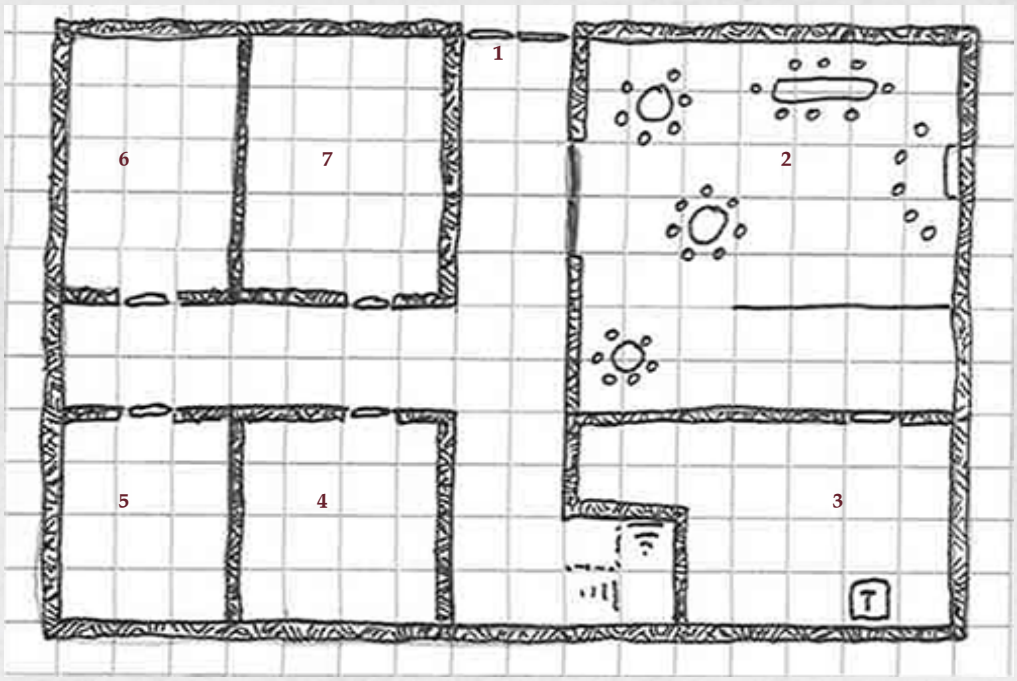
1. Entrance

The wooden door is iron wrought and intricately carved, showing a large boar rushing through the undergrowth in a dark forest. It's unlocked. Beyond is a well-lit hallway and in the other end is a small desk, where Dalizmir can often be found. He writes every guests name into a large leather-bound book and for how many nights they intend to stay, and later how many nights they stayed.

> As you step into the inn a thunder rolls across the sky. The inn is warm and the smell of cooked meat and spiced potatoes fills the air, bringing water to your mouth. A great chandelier made of deer antlers hangs above a small desk. A burly-looking man, with grey streaks in his dark hair, looks up and smiles. "Welcome to the Weary Boar," he says, his accent rich. "Come in, come in, friends, and please close the door, better not let the storm in." He ushers you towards his desk.

Dalizmir will introduce himself and ask each PC for a name and how long they intend to stay. He will carefully note this into his large book. The night costs 5 sp and simple breakfast (oatmeal and bread) is included. For 2 sp the breakfast includes bacon and eggs. The dinner costs 3 sp and includes deer meat, vegetables, bread and potatoes. Dalizmir also tells the

First floor



PCs that they just received barrels with new Vallakan wheat mead, a pint costs 6 cp, before handing the PC over keys to their rooms.

> "The common room is over there and your rooms are on the second floor. Please, make yourself at home, my friends," Dalizmir points to a door to your left. "You can dry your clothes by the fire. If you need anything just ask Zirry or Dana."

2. Common room

> You enter a large common room. The other guests that are there cast a glance your way. A large fireplace dominates one wall in the other end of the room, where there are also few deep and cozy chairs. Three round tables stand in your end. An elderly lady stumbles over to you, drying her gnarled hands in her apron. "Welcome, milords and miladies. Iffen you please, you can sit by that table," she says with a shaky but raspy voice and points towards one of the round tables. She walks over to the table, pulls out one of the chairs and waits, smiling.

The room is 25x40' and spacious. There are three round tables by the door but sofas and chairs by the fire. There are pegs on the wall beside the fire, so that guests can hang their clothes to dry. When the PCs enter the room, there are three other guests there, Lady Destonichy, Kalvin and Milos (see NPCs), along with Zirry and Viola. The old woman will bustle about and make sure that the PCs get everything they need. She will take their wet clothes, if they like, and hang it by the fire.

3. Kitchen

The kitchen is large and well equipped with all kinds of pots, pans and everything a good chef needs. There's a trap door in one corner that leads down to the cellar.

4. Locked room

The door to this room is locked. With a successful **DC 15 Dexterity check** the PCs manage to unlock it. This used to be Nyanka's study, where she'd write in her diary, knit and spend her days.

> You finally pick the lock. The door opens with high-pitched squeak, that sounds almost like the room laments being open. The room beyond is dark and dusty.

There's a small dusty desk in one corner, where Nyanka hid her diary, when she started that Dalizmir would hurt her. On the desk is a woolen baby-sized sweater and knitting-needles with almost-ready same sized pants. With a successful **DC 13 Intelligence (Investigation) check** the PCs discover the secret compartment. It is locked and trapped with a Needle trap (see DMG p. 123). Within the compartment is Nyanka's diary (see handout 1).

5. Zirry's room

She usually locks her room, since she has the feeling that something is not right in the Weary Boar. With a successful **DC 13 Dexterity check** the PCs manage to pick the lock. The room contains a bed, a cabinet and a small bedside table, containing an old silver necklace worth 3 gps.

6. Lana's room

The room is identical to Zirry's room, though it doesn't contain a silver ring. The bedside table contains 2 books, both on cooking.

7. Master bedroom

The master bedroom is used by Dalizmir and Viola. It has a large double bed, which has boars engraved in the bedposts. There are two cabinets and a desk. Beside the bed are bedside tables and in Viola's bedside table is a golden necklace, bearing the holy symbol of the Morninglord. With a successful **DC 10 Intelligence (Religion)** the PCs recognize the holy symbol, if the PCs are native to Barovia. With a successful **DC 15 Intelligence (Religion)** check the PCs see a connection to Lathander, the god of hope, if the PCs are from Fearun.

Second floor

All the rooms, except for room 12, are identical, with a simple bed and a small cabinet, and a small round window above the bed. Water basin and a shaving mirror rest on a small table beside each bed.

8. Zoltan's room

Zoltan keeps all his weapons and gear in the room. The room is locked.

9. -10. Unoccupied rooms.

11. Lady Destonichy's room

This room is larger and richer than the other rooms in the Weary Boar. It has a double bed, like the bed in the master bedroom. There's a large cabinet and a chest, along with a good wooden desk. Destonichy has her family jewels stored in the chest, along with her other possession. With a successful **DC 15 Intelligence check** the PCs know that the jewels are counterfeits.

12. Milos' room

Milos stores his gear in his room, among them is a *Shortsword +1*, which his father gave to him when he was assigned to be Destonichy's guard.

13.-14. Unoccupied room.

15. Room with baby bones

It's important that one PC is assigned to this room.

This room is identical to the other rooms, except that in the walls of this room Dalizmir hid the bones of his baby-boy. With a successful **DC 15 Intelligence (Investigation) check** the PCs discover that some of the panels seem to have been replaced. Making them come loose reveals broken bones of a small humanoid. With a successful **DC 12 Wisdom (Medicine) check** the PCs discover that the bones are human.

16. Unoccupied room

17. Kalvin's room

The gnome merchant Kalvin stores his gear in this room. He arrives only an hour ahead of the PCs so he hasn't settled in yet. His gear is still in his saddle bags.

18-20. Unoccupied rooms.

Cellar

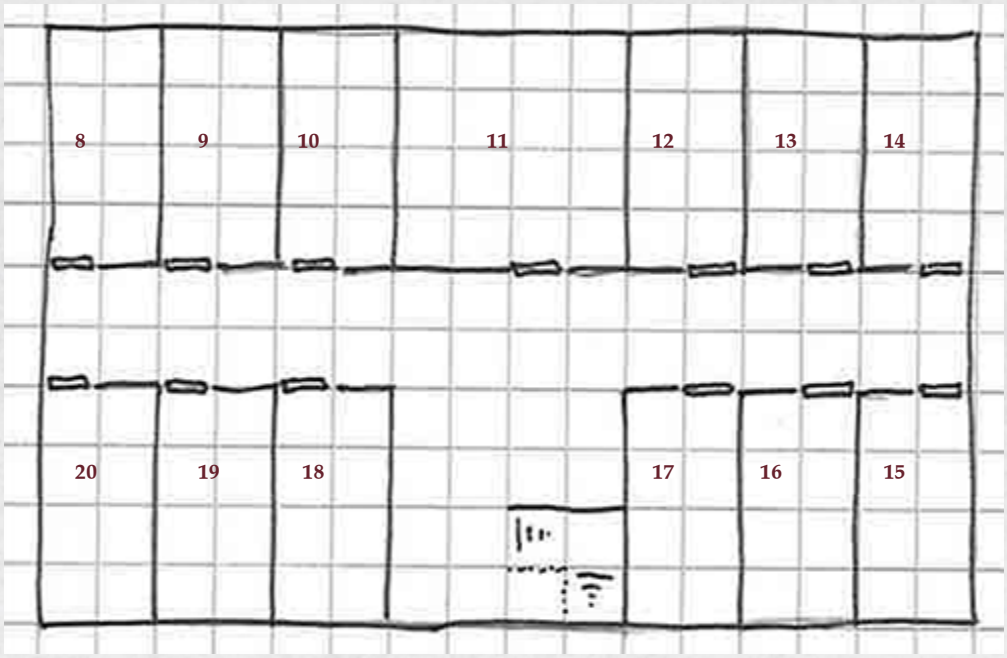
The Cellar is accessible both from the outside and through the trapdoor in the kitchen.

21. Storage room

This is where Dalizmir stores all the goods for the inn, food, ale etc. There are also all sorts of tools, barrels and boxes in the storage room. There's also an ancient well in one corner, with a successful **DC 13 Intelligence (Stonecunning) check** the PCs see that the well is much older than the inn's foundation.

22. Stable

The Weary Boar's stable is well equipped and has room for 8 horses. In one of the stables is a small hidden alcove, with a successful **DC 15 Wisdom (Perception) check** the PCs spot the alcove. Within it Dalizmir stored a leather pouch containing the 9 stones needed to unlock Nyanka's tomb (show the players handout 2).



Events

All the night a powerful storm rages on, with heavy rain, strong winds, thunder and lightning. Feel free to use it to add to the dramatic effect.

Kalvin's murder

An hour before midnight the other guests go to sleep. If the PCs decide to stay up they are free to, Zirry however tells them that the staff goes to sleep around midnight and asks the PCs to make sure they don't make any noise.

Around 1 am Lana discovers that Kalvin has been murdered. She believes that the merchant is rich and decided to see if he has something worth stealing. Seeing him dead in the room however was something she didn't expect. She stepped into the blood pool surrounding the body.

Read or paraphrase the following:

> A loud scream wakes you up. As you manage to turn on a light you can hear shuffling feet in the hallway.

If the PCs decide to check what's going on, read or paraphrase the following:

> You enter the darkened hallway. In the light from your candles you can see that the door to Kalvin's room is open.

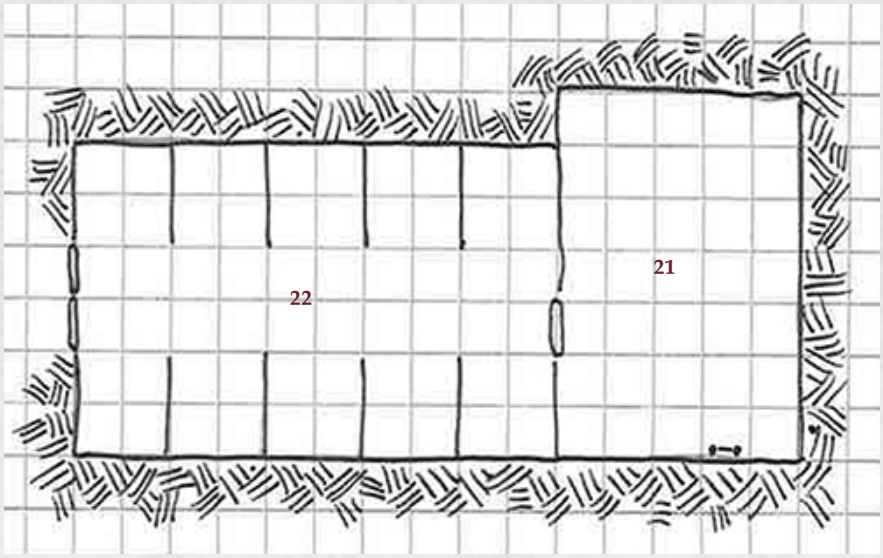
If the PCs decide to check out the gnome merchant's room, read or paraphrase the following:

> As you peer into the room, you can see Kalvin lying on the floor, in a pool of blood. His neck has a gaping wound. His eyes stare at you and the candlelight flickers in them, almost making them seem alive.

With a successful **DC 12 Wisdom (Medicine) check** the PCs know that Kalvin died from the wound in his neck. With a **DC 14 Intelligence (Nature) check** the PCs see that the wound is awfully like the wounds large predators leave on their victims.

If the PCs decide to investigate Kalvin's room, with a successful **DC 12 Intelligence (Investigation) check** they spot a bloody footprint in the room, left by a small humanoid foot. With a successful **DC 12 Wisdom (Survival) check** the PCs manage to follow the track to the stairs down to 1st floor, where it disappears.

If the PCs decide to match up the footprint with the guest's and staff's feet it becomes clear that either Viola or Lana were in Kalvin's room. If pressed or interrogated, Lana breaks down and tells the PCs it was she who found Kelvin. She says that she heard some noise come from the gnome's room and investigated it, she found the door unlocked and discovered Kalvin's body on the floor. With a successful **DC 15 Wisdom (Insight) check** the PCs get the feeling that Lana isn't being completely honest. If pressed she confesses that she wanted to see if the merchant was as rich as he portrayed himself to be. Lana didn't see anyone leave the room nor was the window open when she entered the room.



Kalvin was murdered by Dalizmir. Kalvin recognized Dalizmir for what he is and tried to blackmail the innkeeper, who convinced Kalvin that he'd pay the gnome 100 gp for keeping his mouth shut. When the merchant went to bed, Dalizmir paid him a visit and murdered Kalvin.

While the PCs are investigating the room, Milos and Zoltan appear and offer their assistance. Not long after Zirry and Dalizmir also show up.

All seem sincerely surprised and disgusted when they see the dead merchant. With a successful **DC 18 Wisdom (Insight) check** the PCs get the feeling that Dalizmir is not that surprised and possibly enhancing his reactions.

Kalvin's riches are in his cabinet in a small leather pouch and consist of 37 gp and 12 sp.

The apparition appears

In the darkest hour of night Milos is going back to his room, when an apparition appears in the hallway on the 2nd floor. If there are other PCs present, e.g. if they placed a guard on both floors, they see this as well. If the PCs are present, read or paraphrase the following:

> Suddenly a beautiful woman stands before you, her visage painted with grief and sorrow. She wears her hair long and her almond eyes large. She moves from one room to the next, frantically and desperately. She stops before the door to [insert the name of the PC in room 15] room. She screams, yet no sound escapes from her mouth, before falling down, exhausted. Then she vanishes again.

With a successful **DC 13 Wisdom (Insight) check** the PCs know that she was searching from something. With a successful **DC 10 Intelligence (Religion) check** the PCs discover that this must've been a ghost.

If the PCs are not present, Milos comes running to them, wherever they are and tells them what he saw. With a successful **DC 10 Wisdom (Insight) check** the PCs can tell that the young man is very afraid.

This is the ghost of Nyanka searching for her baby boy. If Dalizmir is present when Milos tells the PCs what happened, his face will turn pale and he will run outside, even is the storm is raging. If Zirry is present, she will recognize the ghost as Nyanka and tell the PCs what she knows about Nyanka.

After the first appearance, whenever a PC is a alone the ghost appears. It never makes a sound and seems to be completely oblivious to the PCs presence and frantically searching for something. Feel free to use the apparition any way it suits your game and adds to the atmosphere.

Zirry leaves

An hour or so after news of the apparition start to circulate Zirry decides she has had enough. She has often mentioned that something evil is in the house to Dalizmir, but he refuses and tries to talk Zirry out of it. Dalizmir tries to stop her but to no avail.

With a successful **DC 14 Wisdom (Perception) check** the PCs hear a heated argument downstairs by the front door. If they decide to investigate it, read or paraphrase the following:

> You find Dalizmir and Zirry standing by the front door, in heated argument.
>
> "I refuse to stay here a moment longer. Something evil is in this house but you refuse to listen to me. I've been telling you this for years, Dalizmir," Zirry pushes past the innkeeper. "Now all this, murder and ghosts. I can't take it anymore." Zirry opens the door. Roaring wind suddenly fills the foyer.
>
> "No, wait, Zirry, at least until the storm passes," begs Dalizmir.
>
> "I won't stay here a moment longer, I'd rather brave the storm and the wolves, than whatever evil stirs in this house."
>
> Zirry runs through the door and disappears into the darkness. Dalizmir calls her name. He turns to you.
>
> "Wait here, I'll try and find her," he says, steps outside and closes the door behind him.

If the PCs wish to follow the night is dark and the storm very powerful. The rain is heavy making it nigh impossible to use a torch. A hooded lantern is a more sensible choice. With a successful **DC 18 Wisdom (Perception) check** the PCs spot a new trail. With a successful **DC 20 Wisdom (Survival) check** they manage to follow it. The trail leads towards Nyanka's tomb, where it vanishes.

Dalizmir and Zoltan fight

Late in the night Zoltan confronts Dalizmir in the common room. Dalizmir loses control and kills Zoltan before jumping in hybrid form through the window, fleeing the scene.

If Zoltan is with the PCs he excuses himself, not

saying that he suspects that Dalizmir is hiding something. With a successful **DC 16 Wisdom (Insight) check** the PCs get the feeling that Zoltan is not telling them everything. If the PCs insist on joining Zoltan he will simply shrug and ask the PCs to not get in his way. Zoltan will go searching for Dalizmir, finding the innkeeper sulking in the common room (or any other room where there are no guests).

If the PCs are with Zoltan, they will witness Zoltan accusing Dalizmir and say that the innkeeper is a were-creature, half-man, half-animal. Dalizmir frowns and tries to back away from the ranger. As Zoltan gets closer, Dalizmir's face changes and takes on a more boar-like features. If the PCs are there they can take part in the fight, but using bows (short and long) and medium or large weapons is with a disadvantage due to the close confinements of being indoors. Zoltan, who has one silvered weapon (a dagger), defends himself. Dalizmir will fight furiously for three rounds before jumping through a window and escape into the dark night.

If the PCs aren't with Zoltan or decide not to follow him, read or paraphrase the following:

> You hear a terrible roar, coming from the common room, followed by sounds of struggle.

If the PCs decide to investigate, read on:

> You find Zoltan lying on the floor, clutching a wound on his chest. The large window is broken and the howling wind has the drapes reaching for you, like writhing tentacles.
>
> "He's… Dalizmir is cursed!" he stutters and blood spills from his mouth. "He is a shapeshifter, a lycan." Zoltan tries to raise himself. "You must stop him. Take this," he hands you his dagger, a beautifully crafted weapon with a silvered edge, "you must stop him before he kills someone else."

With a successful **DC 13 Intelligence (Medicine) check** the PCs see that Zoltan has been gravely wounded and needs healing and rest. If the PCs wish to get more information out of Zoltan, he can answer three questions before losing consciousness, if he hasn't been healed.

What happened: "I confronted Dalizmir and told him I knew his secret. I really didn't know, I just wanted to see if I could frighten him. He lost control of himself, changed shape and attacked me.

Where did Dalizmir go: "I don't know, he crashed through the window and ran. He should be out there somewhere."

What do you know about lycanthropes: "I don't know much. I've been on the trail of a were-creature the last few weeks and it lead me here. I've been finding dead animals in the woods of late, brutally slaughtered. The trail ended here. I don't know much, other than my father's knife seemed to harm Dalizmir. Please take it, you must stop him."

If the PCs wish to speak more to Zoltan, Lady Destinichy will enter the room and beg the PCs to allow the brave warrior to heal. Viola is on the verge of a nervous breakdown and the news about her husband's true nature does nothing to calm her down. If the PCs confront her and ask about Dalizmir she doesn't know where he could've gone, though she suspects that he has either hid himself in the cellar or in Nyanka's tomb.

Milos proposes that the PCs search for Dalizmir, he will guard the three women in the house. Lana agrees and adds that she is more than able to defend herself if push comes to shove.

Triggered events

Zirry's tale

If the PCs decide to speak with Zirry, she will tell them about the apparition and the story of Nyanka, Dalizmir's first wife, if they ask about anything that relates to the house, Dalizmir or the ghost. Read or paraphrase the following:

> "When I came here - seems so many years ago now that I think of it - Dalizmir was married to another woman, a local woman called Nyanka. She basked in Sune's glory, iffen you know what I mean, she was more beautiful than most of the girls from Vallaki and even rivaled the enigmatic Vistani women. She was pregnant. Nyanka used to sit in her study, knit and sew for her unborn baby," the old woman clasps her gnarly hands and sighs. "One day she called out, her water had broken. She was so…" Zirry pauses for a moment, "I would like to say excited, but she was more than that. She was happy and excited, yet so afraid and small. I helped her to her room. A little later the master returned from hunting and told us to leave her." Zirry dries a single tear from her eye. "But fate is a cruel mistress, even more so in these gods forsaken land, for she died giving

birth to her baby, who was stillborn. I sometimes imagine that Nyanka must've seen her stillborn baby and her heart must've broken." Zirry looks at each of you. "You know, Dalizmir was heartbroken and made Nyanka and their baby a beautiful tomb behind the inn. He sometimes visits it. I guess he never fully got over her death. But, ever since she died I sometimes smell her and I imagine that she's here." Her eyes darken. "Mind you, I have often spoken to the master and warned him, there's something evil in this house. Perhaps it's something lingering from before Dalizmir built the Weary Boar, but I can feel it." She casts a furtive glance around. "Sometimes when I'm in the corner room upstairs, I hear something crawling in the wall. And mind you, it's not mice. I know that for sure."

If the PCs ask about Dalizmir Zirry knows that he built the Weary Boar on the foundation on an older house. She doesn't know much about Dalizmir, other than he came from Barovia. She thinks she heard him say one time that he inherited his father's fortune, otherwise she has no idea about how or where he got the money from to build an inn in the middle of the woods.

If the PCs ask more about Nyanka Zirry will describe her as a beauty, with long flowing dark hair and red lips. Nyanka was tall and with mesmerizing eyes. Her description is strikingly similar to the apparition.

The strange ranger

If the PCs decide to investigate the cellar stables after the murder of Kalvin they will find Zoltan there, obviously looking for something in the stable where Dalizmir hid the leather pouch.

There are a few horses in the low ceiling cellar that eye you nervously as you enter. Suddenly someone clad in a dark hooded cloak steps from on the stables. The figure sees you and makes a run for it.

If the PCs came through the kitchen entrance, Zoltan will head for the main entrance. If the PCs came that way, Zoltan will turn to the kitchen entrance. Zoltan has 30 feet move (see Zoltan's entry), it takes him one round to open the cellar door or climb the kitchen ladder. If the PCs catch him, he will at first try to convince them he was simply taking care of the nervous animals. With a successful **DC 15 Wisdom (Insight) check** the PCs know that despite Zoltan's affinity for animals he wasn't solely down there for that purpose. With a successful **DC 15 Charisma (Persuasion) check** the PCs convince Zoltan that they have good intentions and get Zoltan to talk.

Zoltan will tell them that he has been investigating a strange flesh-eating boar. His investigation has lead him to the Weary Boar, where he suspects a were-boar lives. He doesn't know who it is, saying it could be anyone.

Zoltan is willing to help with the PCs' investigation, long as they help him track down the were-boar.

Viola breaks down

If the PCs decide to speak to Viola she will remain steadfast at first. With a successful **DC 15 Wisdom (Insight) check** the PCs feel that there's something more that Viola would like to say, but she's too afraid and pushing the matter would only make her more adamant in keeping silent.

If the PCs speak to her again, especially after Zirry has left, she will break down and confess to the PCs, if they are alone and especially if a female PC has approached her. Read or paraphrase the following:

"I'm so afraid," Viola says, "always afraid. I don't know what to do." She looks at you with tears in her eyes. "I can't tell you, it's too despicable. You'll hate me for it."

With a successful **DC 12 Charisma (Persuasion) check** Viola continues.

Viola takes a deep breath. "I fear Dalizmir, I fear for my baby. I … I don't think," her voice barely a whisper, "I don't think that baby is his." Viola completely breaks down and cries.

Viola will tell the PCs that one night, when Dalizmir was away hunting in the forest, a Vistani clan camped their caravan not far away. She paid them a visit, in hope of having her fortune told. A young Vistani man approached her and they danced the whole night, and she stayed the night in his wagon. She is mortally afraid what will happen to her and the baby once she gives birth to it, for she fears what Dalizmir will do when he sees that the baby has Vistani blood.

Viola doesn't know about Dalizmir's curse, but if the PCs ask what Dalizmir was doing spending the whole night hunting in the forest, she will tell them that he does this every month, even though the woods are not safe, especially with the all the wolves

prowling about. She has never paid it any mind, since he always says that he knows the forest well and knows how to stay away from the wolves.

If the PCs ask about Nyanka, Viola doesn't know much about her, other than Nyanka died giving birth to her son, who was stillborn. She says, that Dalizmir doesn't like to talk about Nyanka and gets very angry if he is pushed. With a successful **DC 15 Wisdom (Insight) check** the PCs get the feeling that Dalizmir doesn't constrain his anger to solely verbal comments. If pushed Viola will confess that Dalizmir has a problem with his anger, but he really is a kind man.

Nyanka's Tomb

Finding Nyanka's tomb isn't hard and doesn't take long, if the PCs have a decent light source, e.g. cast the cantrip Light. It is behind the inn and rests in a small hill.

> After few minutes you find the tomb. It isn't large and rests against a small hill. Two small stone gargoyles with their wings spread stand guard by the door. For moment you feel like the two statues are watching you, but then you discover that it was probably just a play of shadows and the lashing wind. The door is made of stone and seems to be locked with a strange nine-piece lock.

If the PCs have found the leather pouch in the cellar, they can see that the stones in it could easily fit into the holes. They need to be inserted correctly to open the lock. If the stones do not add correctly up, the **two gargoyles** (see MM p. 140)will wake up and attack the PCs. The gargoyles are small (+1 AC) and only have 24 hp each, doing 1d4+1 dmg, +3 to hit.

The lock is a puzzle. The stones need to be inserted to so that each line, both horizontal and vertical, has the sum 15 (see diagram). Their lead is the number that has been appearing in the windows and mirrors, i.e. 6, which is the sum of 1 and 5.

4	**9**	**2**
3	**5**	**7**
8	**1**	**6**

Once the PCs have opened the tomb, read or paraphrase the following:

> As you open the tomb you brace yourself and get ready for some horrid stench and foul air to pour through. Neither happens. Dark stairway leads deeper into the tomb.

If the PCs enter the tomb, the stairs lead deeper into the hill. A dwarf easily sees that the tomb was hastily made and obviously by a non-dwarf. The ceiling is low, mere 8 feet and roots reach down from the roof.

At the end of the stairway is a doorway, leading into a small hall, 30 feet by 40 feet and in the other end is a wooden coffin. In it are the bodily remains of Nyanka.

As soon as the PCs open the coffin Dalizmir senses that the PCs are in the tomb. He will rush to the tomb and attack the PCs, if the PCs open the coffin after his fight with Zoltan. If the PCs are still in the tomb 5 rounds after they open the coffin, Dalizmir will enter the tomb in hybrid form and attack. A PC with a **Passive Perception 14** or higher will notice someone enter the tomb and can warn the other PCs.

> Suddenly what appears to be Dalizmir rushes into the tomb, with foam in his tusk filled mouth. His nose is more like a snout and the hair on his head is coarse and stands out. He roars and attacks.

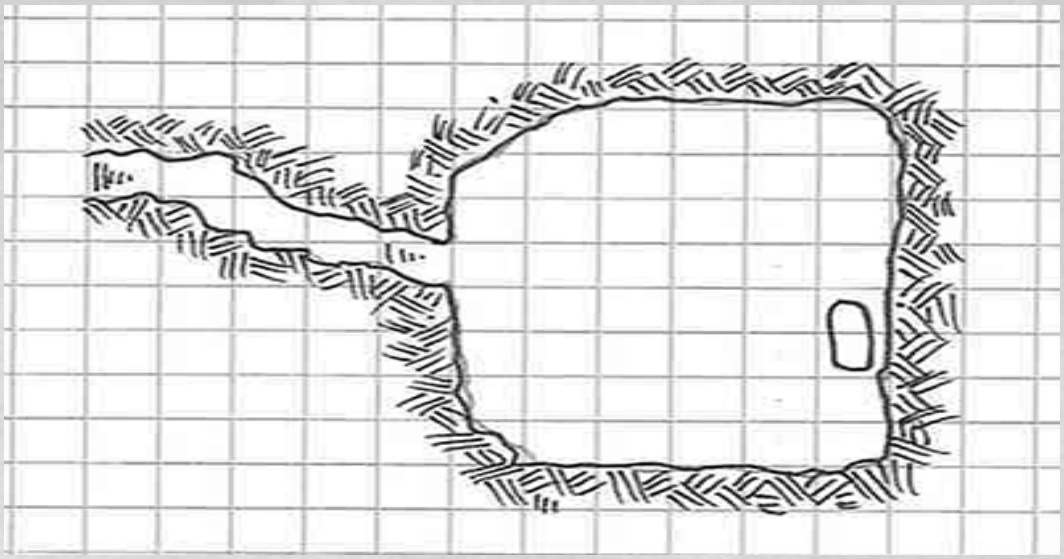
The low-ceilinged tomb makes it really hard to use medium or large weapons, all rolls are made with a disadvantage. However, Dalizmir is wounded from his fight with Zoltan and has only 48 hps.

This is an extremely dangerous fight. Dalizmir is at an advantage, since the PCs cannot use weapons with high damage output. Spells and the weapons Milos and Zoltan gave them are pivotal in making sure the PCs survive.

Dalizmir is wild and attacks whoever is closest to him. He will trust in his damage immunities. He will fight to the death.

If the PCs have found the baby bones and lay the bones to rest in Nyanka's coffin the apparition will appear and express her gratitude. With a successful **DC 12 Wisdom (Insight) check** the PCs get the feeling that the apparition is thanking them. Award the PCs with an Inspiration and the apparition will appear after round 1 and disturb Dalizmir. He will use one of his attacks to fend off the apparition, but it will disappear after 2 rounds.

If the PCs enter the tomb before Zoltan confronts Dalizmir, the innkeeper will stay his hand and do nothing. If, at any other point in the story, place the infant bones in the coffin, Dalizmir will sense the coffin being opened and rush in, and attack whoever



is by the coffin.

If the PCs leave the tomb before Dalizmir manages to come, they will probably meet and fight outside the tomb. Feel free to adjust accordingly.

> As you leave the tomb, you can see the grey light of day stretching across the sky. Though the wind still shakes the trees you feel that the storm is breaking.

Conclusion

If the PCs manage to lay the bones of Nyanka's baby-boy in the coffin, the apparition will finally be laid to rest. If the PCs managed to overcome or slay Dalizmir, Viola will be frantic and hysteric, not knowing what to do. The PCs can help her decide. Destinichy and Milos are more than willing to extend their stay at the Weary Boar and help her.

Lana is eager to leave and will do so at first opportunity. Zirry is found dead by the roadside not far from the inn, her neck has been broken.

Appendix 1: NPCs

Dalizmir

NE Male Human Were-boar (see MM p. 209)

Description: Dalizmir is a short yet stocky human in his mid-forties. He wears a short-cropped mustache and rich side burns. His brown eyes are wild and hard. Dalizmir's nose it small though his nostrils are a little larger than usual. He usually wears white shirt with wide sleeves and dark trouser tucked into his leather boots. When working he wears a red west. His arms are muscular and a bit hairy.

Personality: Dalizmir is courteous, almost sleek and cringingly, towards his guests. With a successful DC 15 Wisdom (Insight) the PCs feel that Dalizmir is trying his best to make sure that his guests like him, even though he doesn't seem to like them. Towards his staff he is gruff and commanding. His relationship with Viola is at best strained now, since she's due in the next 4-6 weeks.

Background: See Adventure Background.

Secret: Dalizmir is a were-boar and a serial murderer. He murdered his wife and baby-boy. He hid the body of his newborn baby in the walls of his inn.

Viola

NG Female Human

Description: Viola is dark haired, with large brown eyes and full red lips. She is in her twenties. She usually wears her hair in a long braid. When working she prefers long skirts and wide blouses. Her smile is beautiful, revealing dimples in her cheeks.

Personality: It's hard to dislike Viola. She greets everyone with a warm smile and seems genuinely interested in people. She is a devoted follower of the Morninglord and tries to restore hope wherever it is needed.

Background: Viola is the second daughter to merchant in Vallaki. She wasn't all too keen on marrying Dalizmir, who she saw as an old man, but her father insisted. She was happy to get away from Vallaki, though her happiness has somewhat dwindled in the last few month, since she has come to realize that Dalizmir is not the man he appears to be and there's something going on in the house that frightens her, though she hasn't, so far, mention anything to anyone.

Secret: Dalizmir is not the father of her baby. She had a one-night affair with a Vistani who happened to pass through. She is terrified that someone might

discover it and what it might mean for her and her baby.

Zirry

CG Female Human

Description: Zirry is an elderly woman, in her sixties though by her looks she could be older. Her eyes are a little cloudy and her hand gnarled. Her leathery skin is wrinkled and she is missing a few teeth.

Personality: Zirry is tough and wise. She knows and feels that something is wrong in the house. She is likeable but she keeps an emotional distance from everything and everyone. She simply does what is asked of her, but otherwise keeps to herself.

Background: Zirry used to live in Waterdeep, where she served as an acolyte of Selune. After years of servitude at the temple, the mists of Ravenloft claimed her. She came to the village Barovia, in hope of finding some explanations but found nothing. She travelled between the villages of Barovia and tried to teach the people about Selune. After years of trying to get the people to revere Our Lady in Silver, she gave up and took the job at the Weary Boar. She hates Barovia and longs desperately to return to Faerun.

Secret: Zirry suspects that not everything is as it appears with Dalizmir. She has seen Nyanka's ghost wandering the second floor. Zirry is also sick, though she hasn't told anyone, for she fears that Dalizmir will throw her out as soon as he learns that she's ill.

Lana

N Female Half-Elf

Description: Lana is tall for a half-elf. She is lean, skinny and wiry and all her moves are quick. Her almond eyes are green and she keeps her red hair long enough, so that it hides her slightly pointed ears.

Personality: Lana is sarcastic and quick with a jab. She's hard to read and busies herself with work. She is decent cook and makes extra-ordinary good bread. She is not eager to speak to any guests and tries to make sure that any guests that enter her kitchen feel that they are not welcome there.

Background: Lana never knew her parents. She was raised as an orphan in Krezk, but ran away after being abused for years. She managed to find her way to Barovia, where she made a living by thieving and stealing. When she was captured, she managed to escape and find her way to the Weary Boar.

Secret: No one knows that Lana is wanted and she wants to keep it that way. She doesn't care much for Zirry. She hates Dalizmir and the way he treats Viola, who she likes more than she cares to admit to herself.

Kalvin

CN Male Gnome Merchant

Description: Kalvin is short and fat. His dark hair is curled and his blue eyes sparkle and come alive as soon as he spots someone whom he thinks he could sell some of his goods. Kalvin wears stylish clothes, of not a bit flamboyant.

Personality: Kalvin is likeable, loves to laugh and make other people laugh. He doesn't take things too seriously. He is a superb salesman.

Background: Kalvin is a charlatan, moving from one village to the next, hoping to sell some of his goods. He has made a living of selling trinkets and almost whatever he deems worthy. His prices are often preposterous and he always goes for the hard sale. Lately his luck has been running out and after a little misunderstanding in Vallaki concerning the burgomaster's wife, he decided to skip town.

Secret: Kalvin fears that the Burgomaster is after him.

Lady Destinichy

LN Female Human Noble

Description: Marabella Destinichy has aristocrat written all over her. She is tall, gaunt and haughty. Her dresses are rich and noteworthy, though a bit last session, so to speak. Her brown hair is flowing but her mouth usually a thin line in her pale face. Her eyes show intelligence, and when she speaks it's obvious that she has been schooled and taught how to speak to people below her.

Personality: Destinichy isn't fun to be around. She doesn't trust the commoners, she constantly fears that they mean to harm her. She keeps distance and makes sure that Milos is never far behind.

Background: Destinichy has just arrived in Ravenloft. She was sent from her father's estate in Alhaster (in Greyhawk) after he heard that she had been involved with a tanner's son. She was supposed to go to the family castle in Dimre, when the mists claimed her and Milos.

Secret: The tanner's son is Milos, but the story that her father heard was a bit skewed. Marabella feels a bit smart, since she managed to convince her father to send Milos with her as her guard.

Milos

LG Male Human Soldier (see MM, appendix NPCs)

Description: Milos is dark skinned and keeps his hair cropped short. He is strong and muscular and carries himself like a soldier.

Personality: Milos is silent and rarely speaks, and then only whispers something to Marabella.

Background: Milos' father was the captain of the Destinichy castle guard. He raised Milos to take his place, teaching him to swing a sword as soon as the boy could walk. Milos, however, was more interested in reading books and studying the Art, something that his father never approved.

Secret: Milos has never seen or been in an actual fight, though he has read much about them.

Zoltan

CG Male Half-Elf Scout (see MM, appendix NPCs)

Description: Zoltan is a weathered and tanned half-elf, who looks like he could be in his fifties. His eyes are the color of an overcast sky and his blond hair is starting to thin. He wears brown leather trousers and a green shirt; his woolen cloak is tattered and dirty.

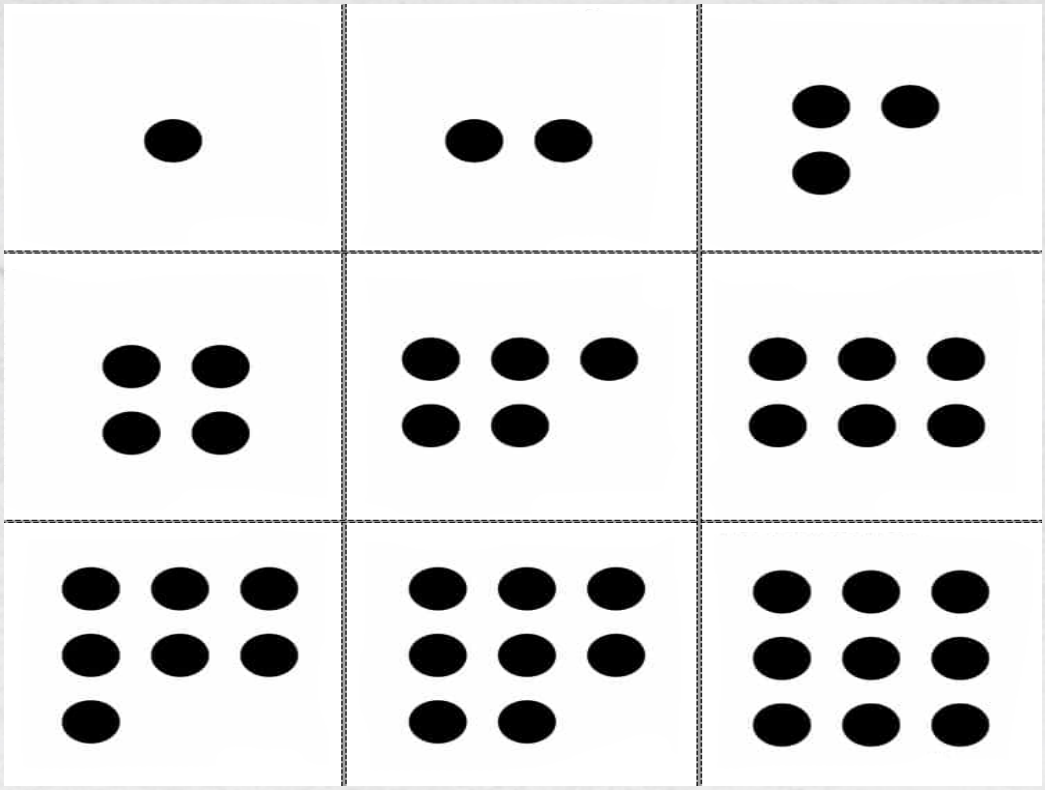
Personality: Zoltan is not a man of many words. He prefers actions. He has a dark humor and prefers the company of animals than people. Once Kelvin is murdered Zoltan starts conducting his own investigation. He doesn't trust the PCs, in fact he doesn't trust anyone in the Weary Boar. He will be secretive and could be used as a red herring.

Background: Zoltan makes a living as a trapper in Barovia village, his farm is just outside the main village. He sells his furs to Bildrath Cantemir, but strives to lead an unremarkable live. Many years ago, his family was attacked and slain while he was away, and ever since he has kept to himself. He blames himself for not being there when wolves attacked his small farm.

Secret: Zoltan suspects that were-wolves attacked his farm and has ever since tried to fight against lycanthropes. His investigations have lead him to the Weary Boar, where he believes a were-creature lives. He doesn't know who it is, but he aims to find out.

Appendix 2: Handouts

Print this out. Cut in 9 parts before handing this out to players.



4th moon, 9th day
This is my first day. It started snowing as we left Vallaki, and we could hear the wolves howl in the woods. Dalizmir, my husband (how strange it is to be finally able to call him my husband) led us through the forest till we came here, after dusk had fallen. I'm still weary from the road, so I will keep this first entry short. I promise, I will write more later.

7th moon, 24th day
I just hired a help, her name is Zirry. She is hard-working and lovely. She quickly learned what was expected of her. I hope that she will make it easier for me to find spare moments so I can find time to fill this journal, but unfortunately that hasn't been so in the last few weeks. It takes time to settle in and there's so much to do in an inn like ours. Dalizmir works day and night, I can sometimes feel him leaving our bedroom, only to find fresh rabbits and deer in the kitchen. He works exhausting day and night, he is determined to make sure that we enjoy the best of what living in the Barovian woods have to offer. Sometimes I worry, for I've heard stories about the wolves in the forest, but he just smiles and says that he has a way with them, he knows where the canines like to hunt and how to escape their notice.

11th moon, 26th day
The year is at an end. A guest came here last night, who travelled from Barovia. She told us that the Count had visited the village. The devil Strahd. I hope he never finds his way to the Weary Boar.

3rd moon, 12th day
I'm so happy. I can't fully express how happy I am. I'm with child. I still haven't told Dalizmir. But I plan to, tonight.

6th moon, 18th day
Strange days. I don't know if it's because I'm pregnant, or if it's something else. Dalizmir is acting strange. One moment he is excited, just as I am, he lies beside me and rests his head on my tummy and sings softly. Then it's as if something happens, his mood turns and he becomes either angry or brooding and keeps to himself. I don't understand why he's like that. I just wish he'd talk to me, but every time I bring it up he gets mad and leaves the inn, only to return a couple of days later, as if nothing happened.

8th moon, 2nd day
Zirry opened up to me tonight. She confessed that she wasn't from Barovia, but from a city far, far away, where she was a follower of a goddess called Selune. She got lost one night in heavy fog and as the mist lifted she found herself standing in a clearing, not far from Barovia. She could see Castle Ravenloft, stark against the night sky. After looking for ways to get back to her homeland, she tried to teach the people of this gods forsaken land, as she calls Barovia, about her moon goddess, she gave up. That's how she ended up here. I wonder how her homeland was like, it must've been ravaged by were-beings, for her goddess Selune, she told me, hates the lycanthropes.

11th moon, 13th day
Oh, how terrible! Why has our happiness been cursed like this? Dalizmir told me last night that he's afraid. He confessed that he has a disease, one that he got from his father and he fears more than anything that our baby might have. When I asked him what kind of disease it was, he only said that it is a terrible disease. I tried to press the matter, but he pushed me away. I started crying, fear got hold of my heart and as I asked Dali again, he got mad, broke my bedroom mirror and screamed that it was something so terrible that if I knew, I would go insane. Then he stormed out of the room and I haven't seen him since. I just hope that he will return soon, I can feel that our baby will come soon.

11th moon, 29th day
I had such a strange dream. I felt as I was walking through the woods, when suddenly the forest seemed to darken. I could feel someone watching me, but as I turned and look around there was no one there. I started walking again, when I heard a wolf howl somewhere close. I could hear the wolves come running, so I started to run, but no matter how I ran, the wolves seem to get closer. Suddenly a large creature burst through the undergrowth and attacked the wolves. I stopped and dared a look over my shoulder. A large boar was fighting the wolves. As it managed to break the wolves and make them flee, it turned towards me. It had six eyes. As the boar got near me, it suddenly stopped. It tried again but again stopped, as if by an invisible wall. It roared and charged head first towards me. My knees went weak as the earth shook beneath my feet, but alas, the invisible wall seemed to stop the boar. It finally gave up and ran away. As I looked up I could see a full silvered moon directly above me. When I woke up Zirry stood by my bed and told me Dalizmir was back.